Scholars describe two sets of reasons why people migrate, separating them into “push” and “pull” factors. The former are external crises like war, discrimination, and economic collapse, which drive people involuntarily from their homelands. For perhaps the first time in history, those factors are irrelevant to the vast majority of diaspora Jews, who are concentrated in stable Western democracies, particularly the United States, France, Canada and Great Britain. Anti-Semitism still exists, of course, but Jewish communities have the political and cultural clout to fight it effectively. (The late Edgar Bronfman, Sr, a prominent businessman and a former president of the World Jewish Congress, once told David Ben-Gurion why he wouldn’t make *aliyah*: “We Jews have found our Zion,” he said. “It is America.”)

Annual immigration dipped as low as 16,884 in 2013, roughly two-tenths of a per cent of Israel’s population. It climbed markedly over the next two years, because of the war in Ukraine and fears of terrorism and anti-Semitism in Europe, but its peak in 2015 was still slightly below 30,000, or 0.35 per cent of the population. That puts Israel roughly on par with other developed countries. (The level of immigration to the US in 2015, as a share of population, was 0.31 per cent; in the UK, it was 0.51 per cent.) Amongst American Jews—who make up fully three-quarters of the diaspora—the annual *aliyah* figures have hovered around a paltry 2,000 for decades.

As for the “pull” factors, the most common is economic opportunity, but here Israel has little to offer. It does boast a relatively low unemployment rate, but also higher prices and significantly lower wages than many other advanced economies. The gap is especially stark for professionals: a doctor can earn five times more in Paris than she does in Jerusalem. The average Israeli family needs 191 monthly salaries to buy a five-room apartment, versus just 71 in Britain. *Aliyah* from the United States spiked by about 25 per cent during the Great Recession of 2008–2010, which Israel weathered better than most countries, but it quickly returned to the trend line as the economy recovered.

Avigdor Lieberman, during his stint as foreign minister, thought he could jump all of these hurdles. He told a surprised audience that Israel could bring in 3.5 million Jews—nearly half of the diaspora—over the next decade, about a twenty-fold increase over immigration levels at the time. (To put this in perspective: if Lieberman lured every single non-American